

1 *Myself and my fellow Travellers*

While a man of the cloth I see my calling as collecting and singing the folk songs of our many varied lands.



We are travelled from the poor lands of the Auvergne, heading south to the Country of Joiry, known for its rich wines and good food. Word has reached us of a Spring Festival in the town of Latour-Rose.

My companions are an odd mix to be on the road but the presence of Luca the woodsman and his bloodhound Rex have proved, I am convinced, of a strong deterrent to many a brigand and highwayman.

Wilhelm the Wondrous, a conjurer of sorts, has a disarming air about him, with many a stranger giving him the benefit of the doubt, seemingly out of nowhere.

Last is the waif Debbs, known as local of the Country and on some errand to Latour-Rose. She seems weak with weapons but her spy glass has come in handy many a time, for danger avoided is danger overcome.

2 *Diary of travelling in the land of Joiry*

2.1 *Session 1*

While travelling to the Spring Fair at Latour-Rose the party discovered a stash of fine Murano glassware, perhaps abandoned due to the recent troubles, and decided to cart it to the fair to sell.

Several days out of Latour-Rose as evening set the party were set upon by a group of goblins and very large timber wolf. Before the wolf, filled with feral cunning beyond what is normal, could attack Wilhelm ensconced the creature. I rushed forward and smote one of the goblins with my scepter and the remaining fled.

I bribe the wolf with a ration of dried meat, for which it was satisfied and disappeared into the darkness.



- *Use ration for wolf*

We travelled on into the darkness, spying what looked to be a giant on a hill some distance away. We hurried on towards a flickering fire in the distance, finding the fire outside a small stony bothy by the roadside.



A group of half a dozen ne'er-do-wells were already occupying the bothy, with a tarp set up to give extra cover. On a fire was a pot with a rabbit stew.

Their leader, a slim man called Evander, invited us to join them. They all looked like brigands except a young woman called Elene, a servant to Andrea de Courte, a merchant from Latour-Rose. I could not determine if she was a captive or not, but we were outnumbered so nobody wanted to push it.

- *Small wiry fellow*
- *Woman with cudgel*
- *Large man with cudgel*

Fortunately Luca and his dog turned up with a brace of conies, enough meat for all our group with some to spare. I broke out my jug of honey wine and shared it around the whole group, reducing the tension and quite possibly saving us from violence.



Both parties eventually settled down for the night, with each group setting a watch. Some time towards dawn the wolf made an appearance but the remains of the stew were enough to keep it from devouring anybody. We left at sunrise and headed along road to the next town.

Reaching the town of Lac-de-fer in the early morning and purchase a meal at an inn called the Leaping Fish. I am incensed to hear a cult known as the Tideborn has occupied and desecrated the church in the village.

- Spent 2sp for good breakfast

However mindful of the valuable cargo we were carrying and our few numbers I held my wrath in check. We were forced to sell one of the glass goblets to the local bargeman for passage across the lake.



On the barge we were accompanied by The Three Players, a troupe of entertainers named Y'slen the Magnificent, Breagle the Strong and Eloise. As we crossed the waters a small fishing boat approached and we were accosted by one

Carlu the Corsair, a cruel-faced fellow with an impressive moustache. He claimed to be searching for a Lady Anwyn and demanded to search and stab the womenfolk on the barge.

With swift action from Willhelm and Luca the corsair's bowmen were robbed of the bows and with a mighty push by Luca the barge lurched away from the boat, causing the corsairs to plunge into the water rather than leap aboard. Both the boat and the barge hastily rowed and polled away, leaving them to flounder.

2.2 Session 2

We enter the town of Latour-Rose and are greeted by local guard and gardener named Antoine. He recommended going to Monsieur Boutin, the stall manager, who is at the center of the town.

- The Juggler's Zeal
- River running through the center of the town
- Castle falling down
- Baronial square has palace

Monsieur Boutin recommends two stall holders, M d'Salice and M d'Courte, for selling the glassware to, otherwise we can hire a stall in the main square, at the cost of 100sp per day and 1/20 of the sale as taxes. The alternative is to set up in the Pauper's square, which costs nothing, apart from the tax. However selling valuable items in the pauper's square is to invite theft and there will be few buyers.



Henri the guard clears a path to M d'Salice and M Boutin quietly suggests not taking anything less than ten talens for glass. After a short discussion we depart, followed by an non descript character by the name of Martin.

At M d'Courte he offers to sell it on our behalf, taking a fifth as his cut. We sell two pieces to him for a gold talen and 100 silver pennies. Afterward we return to d'Salice and sell the remaining items for ten talens and 200 silver pennies, immediately splitting the money so each receive two talens. We are recommended the Hungry Cock by Martin as a place to lodge for the night.

Spend the remainder of the day shopping, encountering a number of strange people including Kallak the Thread Merchant and Lady Snikka.



- Spent 1 talents buying a new set of cloths
- Spent 1 talent on book and hourglass

I purchase a new set of travelling robes and boots, an hour glass and a book containing local folk songs.

We return to the Hungry Cock and while supping out evening meal are set upon by Martin and a crew of thugs. Somehow Lady Snika gets involved and steals a boot from right off Luca's foot. After a short fracas the thugs leave with the badly beaten Martin and the inn keeper is forced to hand over 212 silver pennies for this part in the ambush. We depart for fresh lodging. In the proceedings Lady Snika and her dog show they are not what they seem, but some sort of fey creatures.

2.3 Session 3



We spend some time in Latour-Rose, enjoying much that the fair has to offer, and I settle into my new clothes and carefully wear in the boots.

Monsieur Boutin, market-master, has a favour to ask of the heroes having helped them when they arrived in Latour-Rose.

Merchants and other travelers have complained of raids on the northern road. The bandits seem to have made their camp in an old ruin, long crumbled. The ruin is said to be haunted and perhaps cursed, and given the guard are largely volunteers it is proving hard to get anyone to investigate.

The curious thing is the bandits appear more interested in taking captives than treasure, though they take that too. So far no demand for ransom has been received nor prisoner released...

Surely however the heroes, who are brave and armed with faith, steel and magic, will prove up to this task.*

Having spend some time in Latour-Rose the party have picked up some followers and a mule. We acknowledge the favour owed to Monsieur Boutin and after collecting additional equipment and supplies from the town vow to set forth as the fair is winding down.

- Maurice the Muleteer
- Didier the Didier
- Armand the Mendicant
- Rayée (mule)



We head north from Latour-Rose and after a while meet The Three Players, whom we had encountered previously near Lac de Fer. Towards the evening we reach the path, heading off to the left into pine forest, but elect to continue on for another hour and make camp in an existing clearing next to the road.

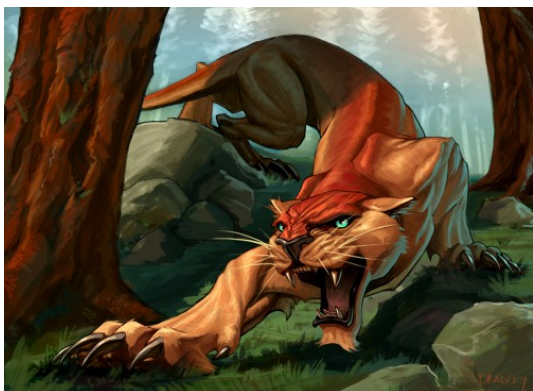
After an evening of song, dance and tricks all have a safe night and leaving the group the party heads back south to the path. After maybe half an hour we encounter a group of peasants gathering snails and mushrooms. They say there is a group rebuilding the ruined temple deeper in the forest and that they had started before the winter. While they group is not particularly large, and might hesitate attacking a group of five there has been a giant feral cat stalking the area for the last few months.



We pay an old woman five silver pennies to show us way to the temple, another three to four hours further into the forest. After a while on the path the mule refuses to budge so it is tied off in a thicket some way of the path.

We continue on for a good hour before discovering some concealed leycap mushrooms, a little way off the path. While gathering them the cry of a wild cat is heard and it attempts to ambush the party. With swift action the cat is taken down with a couple of crossbow bolts and as it lay wounded a cloud of darkness seeps out of its body.

I present the Holy Fingerbone and calling forth the power of our Lord banish the evil back to the Pit. The cat shrinks back to the size of an ordinary feral animal and the party, rather than slay the beast or leave it to die, patch it up with bandages and salves.



We track through the forest for another couple of hours, staying near but not on the path. Nearing the temple I stash my cart a little off the path and while doing so hear voices approaching along the path towards us.

Carefully stealthing through the underbrush we spy two people in black robes pushing a cart with a corpse loaded onto it. In conversation they say it will only be another few nights before the great work is done. We track the cultists to a stream where there a number of bodies, possibly even half a dozen, dumped near the water.

An ambush and melee ensue and both cultists are rightfully slain. The corpse is that of a merchant who was in Latour-Rose for the faire, by the name of Vincent Guerin.

Leaving the stream and grisly occupants we return back and after an hour and a half reach a stone wall. Beyond is some sort of chapel or temple, and the sounds of a couple talking.

Another melee ensues with one of the cultists, a woman of unknown description, animating two corpses with foul necromancy. I destroy one with my vial of holy water and the other is eventually beaten down.

Inside the temple there is a dark altar which is being restored by blood sacrifice but it cracked by me striking it with my lit censor. The woman manages to escape using some sort of darkness magic but leaves her book behind.

After it all over we capture two cultists, a woman with a burnt face and a large burly man. We rescue two teenages, who are the son and daughter of Vincent Guerin.

By the altar are stairs going into a cellar and within is a chest and a statue of of a toad god, which is destroyed. Around the cellar are strange runes carved into its walls and on reviewing the book it seams the cultist leader was attempting to transcribe them.

The chest reveals nine gold talens, 466 silver pennies, a beautiful inlaid wooden box worth perhaps 400sp, a box containing one and 1/3 Lightsucker candles and a pair of very familiar Moreno goblets worth 200sp.



The book contains one and 3/4 spells, which Wilhelm claims. We rescue another two people leave the temple, pushing hard to get back to the road by night fall. The following day we return to Latour-Rose and hand over the captive cultists. Later we are feasted by the town and my spend items replaced by the church.

2.4 Session 4

After a short discussion it is decided Wilhelm should hold the Lightsucker candle, as nobody else wanted to be associated with such dark sorcery. Due to its fragile nature it needs to be kept in a sturdy box.

A few days after our return Father Jan asks if can escort Brother Fabien to the Priory of Ste. Elodie de la Forest, which is deep in the Forest du Tarascon, the same forest that the fallen temple is.

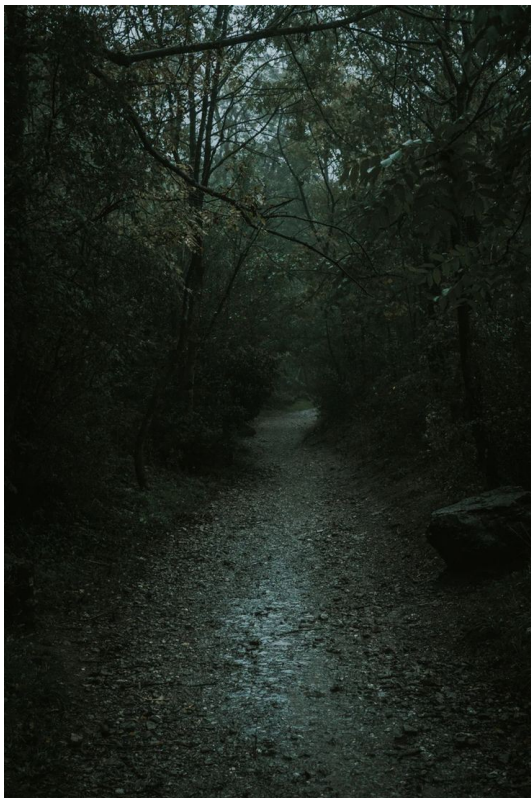
It is pressed upon us there is a path through the forest to the priory and that while poorly tended the denizens of the forest will not harm those who travel along it.

However there are bandits, and dispossessed men following the war, that roam the forest however and Brother Fabien carries a valuable hymnal so it is thought unwise for him to travel alone.

The church does not offer coin for this service but rather will pay in gear, provisions and room and board.

Brother Fabien is a large and watchful man, and strikes me as a former soldier who has witnessed too much war and horror for this soul to take. While morose and reserved the cudgel he carried spoke of violence repressed.

The group, five men, a mule and my hand cart, set off north along the road, laden with six days of travel rations. The path leading to the priory is not as far along as the path to the temple and we camp on the road over night before heading in.



After a couple of hours into the forest meet a group of 20 peasants who are forging for mushrooms and other materials. Luca offers some rations and we stop and have a short second breakfast with the group.

Their leader warns us to always stay on the path, for it is a blessed path, and provided we do not do violence to the forest the forest and its creatures will not harm us. However men are not bound by this and they speak of a group of deserters further to the west (along the path).

The peasants say this close to the road it is safe to stray off the path but they do not travel further in, particularly because there are men further along.

We continue along, the path slowly closing in but wide enough for the mule and cart, until we reach a fallen tree. Luca is a fine woodsman and his sharp axe makes good work, and between myself, Fabien and the mule we clear the cut pieces off onto the sides. I stack up some of the wood onto the cart for later use.

After not more than half an hour Luca detects the smell of woodsmoke from a recently doused fire. I use the wood to create a small barricade across the cart as a form of cover, should bowmen appear.

Luca steals forth and spies a camp set up on the path, with four tents, with five men and a single woman. Two of the men have bows, while the leader has an axe and the others have knives.

Returning, Luca formulates a plan for myself and Fabien to wander towards the camp with the flagon on honey wine, singing and staggering as if we had imbibed too much.

This occurs, and their leader, Martin the Bloody, demands we surrender. Feigning surprise and fright we flee back to the cart where Luca lies in wait.

Throwing away their advantage with having bows the instead charge after us and are taken by complete surprise when hold our ground strike with weapons.

We are hard pressed, with three verses five, but to my surprise the woman stabs one of the deserters in the back and when he turns to remonstrate, stabs him again in the chest. After that we gain the advantage, but not before Luca and Fabien take wounds. Martin surrenders but before the woman, having finished off two of her wounded compatriots, can go to work on him Luca beheads him.

We gather up a couple of bows and arrows, but there is little else the deserters have on them, or in their camp. The woman, Gaelle by name, claims to be held against her will. Luca seems skeptical but considering she acted against them is given the benefit of the doubt.



Towards the evening see torches off the path and we hear singing. We all stopper our ears and avoid looking at the

lights. Camping, we set a watch with myself, Maurice and Armand, but are not disturbed.

Travelling on for next half a day it gets slow and boggy but we find a stream so we wash the dirt and blood of the bandit encounter.



At noon see a pack of six wolves lying across the path. Luca initially tries to shoo them away with a stick and I try with the smoke of the censor but in the end it takes a large fire and plenty of smoke to drive them away. This takes a couple of hours and it starts to rain. We push on and are forced to wade waist deep through a puddle blocking the path. This takes quite some time and it getting dark as we start moving again.

After setting camp a voice calls out to us, and a satyr named Ilikon offers us sustenance. After ensuring no fey trickery we welcome him and are plied with a fine rich wine, heady and strong.

A friendly competition ensues and with my lead and Fabien's rich baritone accompaniment the satyr is bested and in return we are taught a Song of the Forest.



Afterward more fey arrive and revelry ensues, with Gaelle dancing wildly with Ilikon. Ilikon tries to get Gaelle to join them, and after much discouragement from Luca and myself, chooses to go for a year and a day, and only with Ilikon, with the promise of a gossamer dress, meeting the elf king and riding of the back of a bumble bee.

In return we are given the flagon of wine and warned that path goes near the elf kingdom, who are beautiful but fell. In the morning all wounds are healed and wake up refreshed but with a hangover.



Off the path are three tall slender figures with cat's eyes, silver hair and armed with swords and bows. They are elves of the forest, their leader called 'Eloriel.

We are invited to the 'Elf Court, but we all politely decline, although I offer to come after our task is done, for I quest for song and tales, and I'm intrigued by their statement that there are places mortals can go that they cannot.

They generously give a parcel of six honeycakes each of which can keep a man fed for a day, and an Elfwhistle which may be blown once for aid and then must be returned (if blown again it will still call something forth) and three Trueflight arrows (d12, 50% chance of being retrieved). I offer to quest a trifle for them and they give me fine wooden box in which you are to capture the laughter of a child, which will not rob the child of voice or future merriment.

It rains heavily through out the day so slow going but we are not attacked and towards the end of day see a palisade and a group of monks attending the area inside.

We are taken to Friar Thomas and both Fabien and the hymnal are safely delivered. After Evensong an early night is welcome with a warm cot in a dry room.



2.5 Session 5 - 2026.02.09

Clara, the pretty young daughter to the Baron Latour's head laundress, has gone missing. It is feared she caught the eye of the cruel Vicomte de Malmont.

Clara is due to be married soon. The head cook Mathilde asks Debb and her companions to help, having befriended Debb when Wilhelm and Debb were recently attending the castle. As Wilhelm entertained, Debb was taken care of below stairs.

Can the heroes find Clara before she is ruined?

While Luca and I make our way back from the Priory Wilhelm had been requested to do a command performance for the Baron Latour and his court.

While Wilhelm was performing one of the Baron's guests, Vicomte Henri de Malmont by name, threw a dagger at him. While Wilhelm was not injured the trick was ruined. Later a half gold talon is also thrown by Malmont but this time Wilhelm caught it.



While this was happening on stage Debb was in the kitchen with Mathilde, the head cook, a large woman of maybe 40 years. It seems that Debb and Mathilde had crossed paths some years earlier when Debb was in the care of nearby wise woman.

It seems Mathilde has taken a shine to Debb and introduced her to the head of the baronial household, a Madam Chastain, who, while skeptical of Debb, accepted her desire to learn to dance is a genuine attempt to improve herself and her station, and organised some introductory lessons with one of the dance masters.

The following day Luca and I return and Debb says Mathilde has requested assistance from the party. Within the household there is a laundress named Leia, who has a daughter Clara. She is due to be married to the son of Antoine, the cobbler and some times town guard.

When we are arrive, some time midmorning, we are plied with a proverbial feast of game pie, wine and other quality food and beverage. While the rest of us tucked in to the

fine spread Mathilde and Luca seem to be passing heavy looks between each other, possibly more than what is appropriate in casual company.

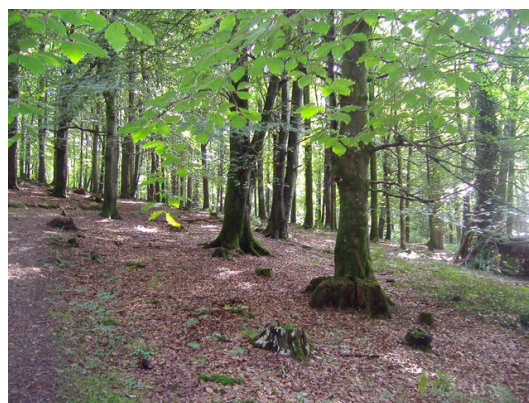


We are told that Clara has gone missing and it is feared she has been taken by the agents of de Malmont, for whom stories tell that he takes captives to his hunting grounds in the Foret de Tarascon and hunts them for cruel sport, given gold to those few that escape but otherwise inflicting punishment on those re-captured.

We decide to set off to this lodge, collecting some garlic salts and spoiled meat to confounds the hounds of the hunts, while Luca is given a flask of fortified port and all given a fine packed spread for the road.

Antoine joins us for the road for he has been there before as part of this guarding duties. He tells there may be half a dozen guards at the hunting lodge but one of the, Pierre, is a good man come upon hard times, and may be turned. They are said to be lead by master huntsman, Serge, a brutal and cruel man.

It is near moon by the time we set off and travel along the now well known road to the north. At some point Luca's rodent travelling companion makes its appearance again, much to Antoine's surprise.



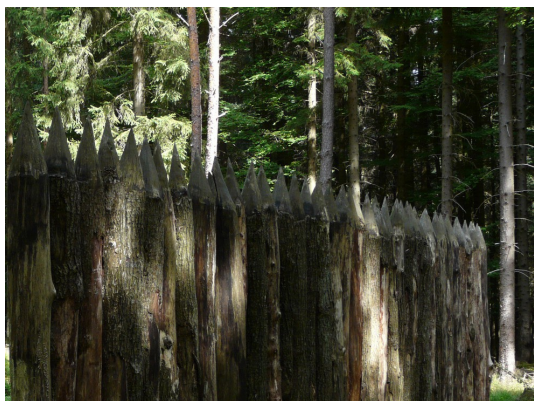
After a quiet and peaceful night camping near the road we enter the forest down a well kept path. Luca finds a pinch in the path and fells several trees to form a substantial baracade, carving into it words to the effect that it is the work of the Merry Bandits of Latour-Rose.

On a side note the Candle lasts a couple of hours per use but make the volume pitch black.

A short few hours after noon we reach the hunting grounds, a high palisade encircling them with a single large

gate through. Somewhere inside is the lodge itself. Luca scouts the perimeter and finds a number of places where trees have overground the wall but we would not be able to get the mule or cart across.

There is a guard hut outside the gates with two guards. Antoine indicates there will be maybe half a dozen guards all up, a similar number of beaters, and possibly a score of servants in the lodge.



Debb tries to distract the two guards while Luca stealths forward. Debb spills the fine packed lunch, for which I am still upset about it, and one of the guards scrambles to retrieve the food. Then without warning Luca strikes down with a savage blow of the axe while the second is cut down with crossbow fire before Luca finishes him off.

The two other guards, who were inside the gate, come out to see what is going off. Wilhelm charms one of them while the other flees, Luca going off in pursuit. We enter through the open gate and stable the mule by the guard house, which has a small fence around it. The inside of the grounds is much like the woods we had travelled through save an area around 10 feet from the palisade has been cleared, making escape a difficult prospect.

While Wilhelm distracts his new found friend Debb departs after Luca. After a bit we hear dogs and Antoine says the beaters and huntsmaster will be out setting traps.

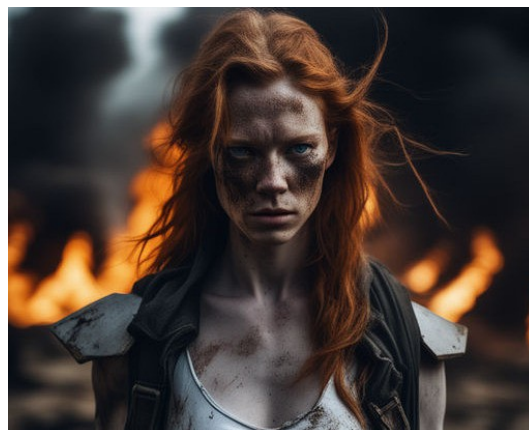
Wilhelm and I, along with the last of the gate guards, heads down a well maintained path towards the lodge. A little way along we both attack the guard, slaying him, and hide the body in the trees.

From the distance we can hear horns, the baying of hounds and other comotion, so we push on and reach the lodge. The call has gone up so I crash through a window before it can be secured by shutters, the servant fleeing before me. Wilhelm follows, his dash across from the trees not noticed by the group at the main entrance.

Inside we sneak along a corridor, ducking into a side room near the entrance. From outside a bloody and enraged Luca starts rending the door with his axe while Debb screams the Red Cap will take them all.

Inside mutiny and chaos reign and I attempt to surprise Serge with a crafty crossbow attack. He charges us and I manage to duck and strike him in his manhood, but not before Wilhelm suffers a new mortal blow. I finish Serge off with a crushing blow to the back of the head and we are almost attacked by Luca in his red mist.

While Debb sees to Wilhelm Luca and I canvas the lodge, finding the prisoners in a cell in the cellar. After quite some time everybody collects themselves and we head back towards the gate, the remaining servants, guards and beaters no where to be seen.



We collect our assorted company from the gatehouse and Luca sets a trap he had found on the path. Debb arrives late, having set the lodge ablaze. We take a crafty path back through the forest, missing de Malmont but by a few short minutes.

A day later we return to Latour-Rose. I leave to join even-song at the chapel, the others to our lodgings and Luca to some secluded pantry with the grateful Mathilde.

Later de Malmont, his man companion Le Chevalier Roger Lavigne, his man Alex and guard Bruno, along with his retinue, also arrive back in Latour-Rose. Rumours from the street are that he was incandescent with rage for the fire had gutted his lodge, but also his evil deeds had stirred the forest against him and sent forth a revenant to deliver justice and punishment.



The Vicomte and company depart Latour-Rose the following day while I contemplate the breaking in a new pair of travelling boots hand crafted by Antoine.

2.6 Session 6 - 2026.05.27

As the heroes proceed to the great southern city of Lussan a request reaches them by rider. Following their recent success with the cursed temple and their skill navigating the Foret de Tarascon, could Luca and the Friar detour into the woods near Lussan to investigate rumours of a band of evil outlaws who plague a little used forest road.

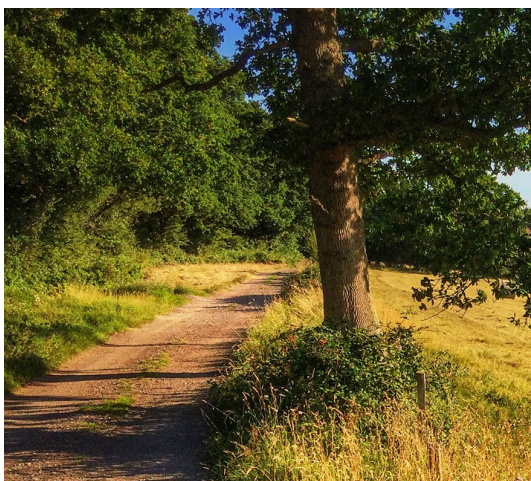
The messenger carries a letter from the Baron de Latour commanding the people of a nearby village to offer all accommodation and support in this endeavour.

You've dealt with several such bands to date so it should be a matter of little import.

Debb and Wilhelm meanwhile have an invitation sent by messenger from Lussan to attend a ball in support of Yslen the Magnificent and her band of players. So basically they're staff but a ball is a ball. The ball incidentally is being thrown at the mansion of the charismatic yet reclusive Chevalier de Carpathie, a Carpathian nobleman by name Ciprian Albescu. Not that it matters since it's offscreen.

Luca and myself, and our companions, are nearing Lussan when we leave the main road and head towards Chames du Bois, while Debb and Wilhelm head directly to Lussan.

It is summer time now and the land is rich with fruit, berries and game. The road to Chames du Bois is cobbled but has not seen much travel of recent.



We stop for lunch and take our ease for the note indicates the problems are beyond the village and there has been no troubles on this section of the road. Finding a shady glade by the roadside I hunt for some mushrooms like Luca takes his easy.

Not long after we settle a traveller comes down the road with a mule pulling a cart, which seems to be carrying many wrapped packages and bottles.

He introduces himself as Gilles the peddler, but also does a side trade in sharpening knives.

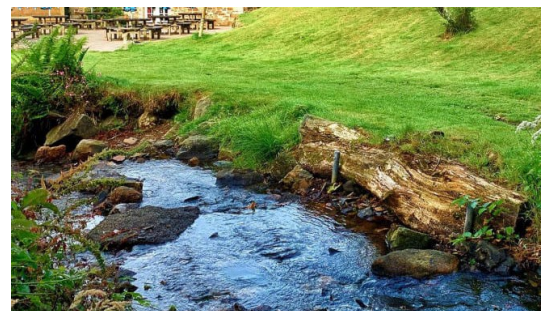
He describes the town of Chames du Bois, with its large inn called the Leaping Fish, and the small stream running through it. He tells us a few hours beyond that is a much larger stream, swift flowing in places but easily forded where it meets the road. There is a shrine to Ste. Elodie de la Forest, and the stream itself is holy.

After making a holy sign he also warns us beyond the stream are the bandits and it is rumoured they are capable of taking the form of terrible beasts.

After a fine lunch of fried mushrooms and onions with some spicy salami, disturbed only by Gilles sharpening Luca's axe for a modest fee, we set off again, with Gilles joining us, his day done.

Entering the village of Chames du Bois the impressive inn greets us as it by far the most substantial building in the village. We reach the inn and are greeted by the landlord Girard and his son Mattieu. Girard has a fine set of sideburns but there is a haggard look to him.

We decamp to the back of the inn where there is a garden that overlooks the stream. There a couple of dogs lazy in the run. Luca and I, along with our companions, slake our thirst with some cellar chilled ale.



Girard, after some prompting from Luca, reveals this daughter, Jacquette, a dark haired, beautiful and a little wild, bored of living in the village, packed her finest cloths and left for the west.

As it summer and daylight to spare, Luca and myself leave the others and head along the road to the west, reaching the stream as the sun is starting to settle. On this side of the stream is a small shrine, not large enough for a person to enter, well kept with with many offering. Across the stream a bucket on a windlass, so that the stream water can be captured without entering the stream itself.

I get the sense we are being watched from across the river but nothing can be seen in the twilight. We head back to the village with the feeling of being under observation right up until we reach the village proper.

Returning to the inn it is busier then I would have expected and it felt like the whole village had turned out for us. From the locals we hear a group of travellers had come through a month back from the west and had lost one of the number, before headed south to Latour. I feel they must have some standing for we are well outside the realm of Baron de Latour.

We also hear that Old Guiot, the local Cunning Man, and his servant Adam, have also gone missing in the last few months. Upon hearing of the quality of the water from the stream Luca and I get half a dozen old wine jugs to be filled. The attacks themselves seem only to happen at night.

The road beyond the stream passes and woodman's cabin and further after that an old ruin. Eventually it reaches a much larger road that cuts through the forest.

In the morning we set out as a group but Luca feels we will be better without our companions and cart, so they are sent back to the village while we ford the stream, fill the wine jugs and continue on.



After some time we find a corpse of a deer that has been torn apart and killed last night by a pack of creatures. There is a sense of wanton destruction and on this is the result of an act of evil most foul.

A little later we find the headless corpse of a rabbit draped over a tree limb. Luca's hound Rex is less repelled by the scent and gives the impression this was not done by the same group. With that Rex tracks the scent and we find a small rock cave and from within a man's voice can be heard.

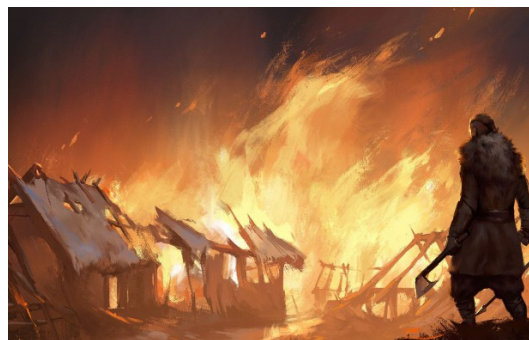
Luca enters and there is an old hermit, whom Luca drags out into the sun and pours some stream water over him. The hermit screams and vermin swarm from him and attack Luca, without any real success. The hermit then cries "Spare Old Guiot", which we do, instead binding him.

Guiot says his servant is now a madman that roves the forest but is not the source of the attacks. Instead there are three, named Guillaume, Robert et Henri, the three 'bandits', who serve a master who has gone to Lussan.

After more questioning Old Guiot admits to crossing the river after hearing rumours that power could be had there. He also says Henri wooed Jacqueline and she crossed the river to be with him, and the bandits currently reside in the woodman's cabin.

Taking Guiot with us we proceed to the cabin, which is much larger than I expected, a single story with several rooms and a large barn at the back.

Luca sneaks forth but it is dark and musty inside, but does make out a kitchen and another room with a large amount of straw. His mouse then sneaks in to scout and report back, and after some time returns, saying there are three men curled up in the hay in the middle of the cabin, presumably asleep.



We quietly bar and block the doors as best we can then set fire to the buildings. I light my censor and waft the smoke towards the burning cabin. A big man with a large mattock breaks out and attacks Luca while I deal with a much smaller, weedy man.

With the use of more stream water and melee strikes we take both of them down, however Luca has his left arm broken in the process. As it becomes clear the third has escaped through another exit we quickly behead the two slain and throw their bodies into the flames.

Until Old Guiot we follow Rex West through the forest in pursuit of Henri. However before we can catch up Adam crashes out of the forest from the trees. Old Guiot flees as we turn to face the lumbering youth, but rather than attack us he breaks down and begs that we kill and behead himself.

We pour more stream water over Adam but while it burns him it does not cure his madness. He says that he was lured by Old Guiot to be a sacrifice so that Old Guiot could gain additional life.

I bring forth my holy relic and use it to purge the curse from Adam. While the curse is instead lifted the curse had done its dark work and filled his body with unnatural life. With the curse gone Adam passes in peace.

We continue our pursuit although we are now some distance behind but eventually reach the ruined tower, which is mostly fallen down but there is an entrance large enough for a large cart to pass through.



We collect some wood and once again sent in the mouse of scout. Before the mouse can return there is a man's shout and a woman's voice in reply. We charge in and it surprisingly shady, with trees having grown up inside the fallen walls.

Henri attacks me with a dagger while Jacquette feigns helplessness. Henri tries to flee from my attack through a small gap in the brush but Rex hamstringing him and I use my vial of holy water on him and then bludge him with my scepter.

I drag the corpse out of the ruin while Luca sees to Jacquette. To my initial confusion Luca suddenly strikes her and between us slay her. Luca then confesses she tried to ensorcel him. With the wood we build a pyre and after beheading the corpses burn the bodies.

We search the tower and find a chest. We return back to the village before night fall then over the next few days collect the stolen goods from the tower and the remains of the cabin.

We tell the village of Old Guiot and Adam, and it turns out he used to spy on people with his magic, but of Jacquette nothing is said except that nothing was seen of her and she must of made it through safely and is living a new life elsewhere.

2.7 Session 7 - 2026.07.20

A deadly beast walks the cobbled streets of Lussan. Reports abound of a large and powerful beast prowling the streets after dark. Few have seen it and those who have only fleetingly. It's roar rebounds from the tall buildings of the city and many have reported a sense of being watched and even stalked. The city's bars and cafes shut early and partygoers hurry home early, travelling in groups.

The heroes meanwhile rest at the questionably famed Dancing House, a mansion now run to seed in a once-fashionable district, so named as it is said to be haunted or ensorcelled and objects left within move around when no one watches them.

The house is run by Madam Lebrun, a strict but kindly woman in her 60s, still handsome. She acts as mother and grandmother to a changing roster of artists, entertainers and chancers who risk the house's curious reputation.

Yslen the Magnificent and her fellow players are guests here and have vouched for Debb, Wilhelm and their friends.



I arrive in Lussan, having travelled from Chames du Bois with Luca and company. My companions decide they want to see the city first while I head directly to the Dancing House.

There I'm met by Wilhelm and Debbs, who tells me several old acquaintances are also staying in the House, in particular Yslen the Magnificent, Breagle the Strong and Eloise.

The streets and the House are abuzz with rumours of the Beast, with descriptions extending to burning red eyes, a tongue of flame and the size of a horse.

I hear a knock at the door and is answered by the maid, Constanza, who declares that because the Lady of the House is absent it our duty to host the guard at the door.

The man at the door is gaering a gambeson and wielding a mace, and introduces himself an Landri, Sergeant of the

Guard. We retreat to drawing room off the vestibule, and Landri immediately goes to one of the chests in the room and takes out a bottle of liquor and some small drinking vessels.



Landri tells us the creature has been seen following women and serving folk, including a young noble maiden that Willhelm and Debbs has recently performed for at her engagement party.

He states the sighting have been plotted and center around the Dancing House and has only been seen in the last week, and notes with little subtlety that the party also arrived a week ago.

After leaving I encounter some of the other guests of the House. First was Itzia Sagues, a small, muscular, dark woman, striking and intense. A gifted dancer by all accounts, and able to generate drama from the most mundane activity.

Next was Heloise Guizet, a strikingly beautiful dark haired woman in her early 30s, blessed with a voice of remarkable grace. I must trade songs but I doubt her repertoire and mine have much overlap.

Other guests include Giraud Amoudry, a tall, blond and handsome lutenist and Ugos Charron, a short, dark, plain man who performs as tumbler and clown. I'm told there are other in House, musicians, entertainers, staff and others of lesser note.

I take my leave and visit the cathedral, magnificent even if still not complete, where I mean to meet Bishop Goncourt, a plump man with a cheerful manner. I entreat him for some blessed spice for my censor and in return I promise to return and sing after supper some evening.

Returning I hear Debbs was caught spying on Itzia and was caught and forced to become her servant, before checking out the attic and being scared away by some levitating boxes.

In the mean time Willhelm scrys around House, and hears variously high pitched chitter chatter, Eloise plotting getting back at a woman, sounds of lots of small feet from

outside and voices of thugs from outside, talking about Martin.

Luca turns us and after some various distractions we head out into the square in front of the house, where a large purple gazebo has been erected in a surprising short period of time.



A large and somewhat fat ginger tom, Balthazar, follows us out, and we are greeted by Kallak the Thread Merchant, who is now running the Bazaar of Hearts Desire.



A beautiful siamese cat, apparently called Nefertiti, also appears and accosts Willhelm for attention before a group of mice come out of the Bazaar and become her focus.

Two thugs are startled from their hiding place nearby and charge towards us. I light my censor and sing a gently lullaby, hoping to engender peace on the evolving fracas.

Willhelm creates his mirror image and the thugs attempt to attack it. Distracted by the failure of their attacks they fail to notice Luca rounding on them, where upon he proceeds to bash their heads together and knock them both out.

Three more appear and the mice hassle them. I give up on any idea of a peaceful resolution and tackle one to the ground, while one flees into the Bazaar and the last attempts to exit stage left, only to be chased down by a Willhelm and his mirror, and surrenders.

After much argument, mostly involving Willhelm threatening to chop fingers off, with Luca favouring bribery with wine and coin, we determine that there are eight in total, including their leader Ugo, whom I had tackled earlier. Their plan was to lay in wait until dusk, when the remaining three would arrive, and then accost us.

It is clear they are working for M d'Salice, who continues to hold a grudge over the sale of the glassware in Latour

Rose. We offer them coin to leave us alone and leave the room to allow them to confer. Scrying on them once more and their leader, Ugo, tries to retain them with a promise of double or triple pay, but the others want no more part in the caper. They wonder what happened to Federic, who was last seen fleeing into the Bazaar.

Returning we agree to give them a silver each for their co-operation and Willhelm cuts their bonds with his sword, but slashes Ugo's hand when it comes his turn. I bandage the wound and give him an extra silver. I'm completely unconvinced it was any kind of accident and I worry Willhelm is possibly heading down a dark path.

We escort the group outside and greeted by Talek and Lady Snikka, who has her pet dog and pig with her. Apparently Debbs had already gone in and been granted a heart's desire. Ugo decides to spend some of his silver and enters while Talek tries to talk Luca into going in.

Another thug entered the Bazaar and returned shortly after carrying a sack, from which the sounds of a clucking chicken could be heard. Rumour later has it that the chicken will lay every day for as long as it is cared for, potentially forever.



I am unable to go in but instead is granted a street festival that evening. Tables and food are set up in the square and people start turning up. I sing evensong and grace, only disturbed by the screams of Ugo from inside the Bazaar. Afterward the party gets started, with Debbs dancing like nobody is watching.

At some point the juggler enters the Bazaar and returns a tall handsome man, proving not all desires have a cost, although I suspect payment will come some time in the future.

Itzia appears and dances across the tables with panache, leaping from table to table like a wild fire. While the music continues Debbs dances, unaware she is totally out-classed, and Luca saves her from the situation by getting up and dancing himself, which pulls the crowd to its feet.

Later on Willhelm spies a huge creature on the roof of the Dancing House, with green eyes, maybe the size of a wolf with a sinuous tail.

The beast leaps down onto one of the tables and it turns out to be a huge black cat, the size of a panther. I attempt to freeze it in place with the finger bone but it fails. The

beast is clearly intelligent as it is aware of actions and looks in my direction.

Willhelm charms it but it runs off, almost knocking him down as it goes. I suspect it will return once it completed what ever it has in mind for the evening.



The beast's arrival and departure ends the evening's celebrations and as people leave I notice three thugs, who must have turned up while I was singing at the start, and have eaten their fill before wandering off, looking both satisfied and a little confused.

Willhelm decides to take up Talek's offer as they will be gone in the morning and is granted the wish, or curse, that he will always be the center of attention.

As we headed back in to the Dancing House I noticed Luca was missing his cloak and I suspect it is now in the possession of Lady Snikka.

2.8 Session 8 - 2026.08.18

It was well after midnight before we all turned in, exhausted from the long evening of song and dance and chaos. I tried to sleep but it took a long time, for some reason Willhelm's movements and noises kept attracting my attention.

Some time before dawn I'm awoken by a loud whisper from Willhelm and in the dim light I spy a pair of almost radiant green eyes hidden in shadowy blackness from across the room.

I did not respond and Luca merely turned over in his sleep. After some low growls and thuds the Beast bounds away, leaping through the open window and into the night.

While trying to get back to sleep I spy a pair of eyes from the stove. I put out some old biscuits on the floor and a small figure appears and takes the food before disappearing back into the stove. Such curiosities in the Dancing House no longer surprise me.



I finally drift off to sleep and wake late in the morning. In an ordinary inn the time for breakfast would be long past but the artists who mostly inhabit the House seem to be perennially late risers.

Ugos Charron, the previously a plain and rather small man, now tall and darkly handsome, appears at our table, wearing clothes now far too small for him. This juggling and acrobatic skills seem somewhat diminished although it may just be he is unused to his new physique. He seems extremely pleased with the goblin's gift, and indeed it is a remarkable transformation. I advise him to find a tailor with haste as the clothes look equally uncomfortable and seem on the verge of malfunctioning.

Breakfast ends as word spreads across the room that a young serving woman has been discovered dead nearby, her head torn off and all of her blood drained from her body.

We all head over to the scene of the crime, which is guarded by Sergeant Landri. After a short examination it is clear the body has been dumped, for there is no blood at the scene. After blessing the corpse Debbs reluctantly agrees to douse for the missing head and we head to a nearby well.

After drawing a bucket of water the douse indicates directly down and peering into the well I see a severed head floating in the dark waters below. After several attempts we manage to capture the head in the bucket and bring it to the surface where I wrap it in a cloth and take it to the sergeant. It is clear that it has not been cleanly severed, nor clawed off, but instead torn off with great force.

Returning to the Dancing House there is an invitation from Le Chevalier Maurois on the occasion of his engagement to Madame Esclarmonde de Rochefort. I had not heard of either of these people but Wilhelm is invited to perform so maybe we are just there to fill out the numbers.

Debbs notes it will be a full moon tomorrow night and her dress will be wearable. In our room a large wolfskin cloak has appeared. It looks very comfortable but too warm to wear inside.

Returning to the dining hall for lunch we are joined by Heloise Guizet. She too has been invited to the engagement ball but has a very negative opinion of the chevalier, later admitting they had been seeing each other but was dumped. I form an unfavourable view of the man myself for very few of the nobles I have met have been people of morality.

In the afternoon I head to the cathedral to try to do some research and am led to a small dark cell deep beneath the great building. There I am locked in with many dark and terrible works of art. Lighting my censor for comfort and keeping the fingerbone nestled inside my tunic against my skin wards off the darkness but it is still a fearful room.

After reading the Great Book of the Unquiet Undead I gain an understanding of revenants, which are pallid creatures, bloated like ticks when they have fed recently, slain only by decapitation or fire, they otherwise heal all wounds unless staked through the heart. All those they slay rise in turn as similar abominations.



Returning in the evening word reaches us the victim was an under maid that the chevalier, missing for the last three days. They also worked for Monsieur Henri de Courtes, rich merchant who has been kind to us when we were but new.

At supper Itzia Sagues body shames Debbs at the table but even her poison could not destroy the mood, as I sing a jolly drinking song with Heloise Guizet. Later Lady Snikka turns up after the dinner and takes Luca's cap and boot.

After supper we head back up to the room, led by Baltazar, who reclaims the room from the Beast's visit. Luca has paid for a separate room for him and myself and we leave Wilhelm to himself.

In the morning Luca and I head out at dawn to a nearby cove and collect some wooden stakes, flowers, herbs, pine cones and needles, to be used at the funeral after in the morning.

Returning Wilhelm says the beast returned during the night but beyond destroying a chest did no harm. Sadly word reaches the House that another body has been found, a young milkmaid called Lize, who lived not far away.

Luca talks to her distraught father, who states she often went out off an evening, believing she was being courted by a wealthy young man, for she often returned with coin. Luca and I silently draw the same conclusion and set to to speak to her friend Sabine.

Sabine confides in Luca that they we on the game as working girls and Lize broke one of the rules, getting into a carriage two nights previous. She manages to do a crude drawing of the carriage's livery but it not one we immediately recognise.



We enquire of any other missing people and hear that there is another nother young women missing, an inn keeper's daughter, some missing five nights ago. She went out in the evening, putting out some rubbish, and went missing. The area was searched but they only found a single shoe and some carriage tracks.